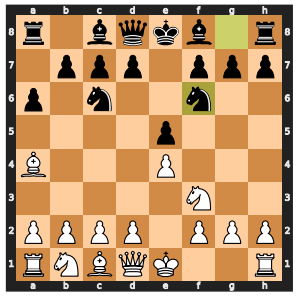
Game 7



# Ruy Lopez

## Capablanca – Burn

### San Sebastian, 1911

White: J. R. Capablanca  Black: A. Burn

*Notes by J. R. Capablanca, from* Chess Fundamentals *(1921), which is in the public domain.*
*Descriptive notation has been converted to algebraic. Page references are to the book.*
*Click any move or diagram to open it on Lichess.*

**1.e4 e5 2.♘f3 ♘c6 3.♗b5 a6 4.♗a4 ♘f6 5.d3**

This is a very solid development, to which I was much addicted at the time, because of my ignorance of the multiple variations of the openings.

**5...d6 6.c3 ♗e7**

In this variation there is the alternative of developing this Bishop via g7, after 6...g6.

**7.♘bd2 0–0 8.♘f1 b5 9.♗c2 d5 10.♕e2 dxe4 11.dxe4 ♗c5**

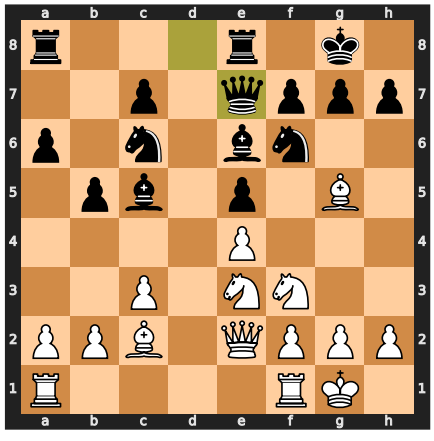
Evidently to make room for the Queen at e7, but I do not think the move advisable at this stage. 11...♗e6 is a more natural and effective move. It develops a piece and threatens ♗c4, which would have to be stopped.

**12.♗g5 ♗e6**

Now it is not so effective, because White's Queen's Bishop is out, and the Knight, in going to e3 to defend the square c4, does not block the Queen's Bishop.

**13.♘e3 ♖e8 14.0–0 ♕e7**

This is bad. Black's game was already not good. He probably had no choice but to take the Knight with the Bishop before making this move.



**15.♘d5 ♗xd5 16.exd5 ♘b8**

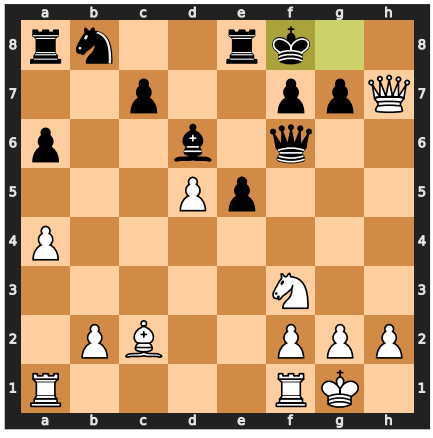
in order to bring it to d7, to support the other Knight and also his King's Pawn. White, however, does not allow time for this, and by taking advantage of his superior position is able to win a Pawn.

**17.a4 b4**

Since he had no way to prevent the loss of a Pawn, he should have given it up where it is, and played 17...♘bd7, in order to make his position more solid. The text move not only loses a Pawn, but leaves Black's game very much weakened.

**18.cxb4 ♗xb4 19.♗xf6 ♕xf6 20.♕e4 ♗d6**

**21.♕xh7+ ♔f8**



With a Pawn more and all his pieces ready for action, while Black is still backward in development, it only remains for White to drive home his advantage before Black can come out with his pieces, in which case, by using the open h-file, Black might be able to start a strong attack against White's King. White is able by his next move to eliminate all danger.

**22.♘h4 ♕h6**

This is practically forced. Black could not play 22...g6 because of 23.♗xg6, and White meanwhile threatened ♕h8+ followed by ♘f5+ and ♕xg7.

**23.♕xh6 gxh6 24.♘f5 h5 25.♗d1 ♘d7 26.♗xh5 ♘f6 27.♗e2 ♘xd5 28.♖fd1 ♘f4 29.♗c4 ♖ed8 30.h4 a5**

Black must lose time assuring the safety of this Pawn.

**31.g3 ♘e6 32.♗xe6 fxe6 33.♘e3 ♖db8 34.♘c4 ♔e7**

Black fights a hopeless battle. He is two Pawns down for all practical purposes, and the Pawns he has are isolated and have to be defended by pieces.

**35.♖ac1 ♖a7**

White threatened ♘xd6, followed by ♖c7+.

**36.♖e1 ♔f6 37.♖e4 ♖b4 38.g4 ♖a6**

If 38... ♖xa4 39.♘xd6 of course would win a piece

**39.♖c3 ♗c5 40.♖f3+ ♔g7 41.b3 ♗d4 42.♔g2 ♖a8 43.g5 ♖a6 44.h5 ♖xc4 45.bxc4 ♖c6 46.g6**
**Resigns.**